

You Have 4 Months Left To Get Ripped & Rich EP 329

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Sep 11, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PtiRMep-0Hc> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter breaks down 5 habits destroying your fat-loss progress (weekend cheating, liquid calories, not tracking, bad environment, too little movement) then delivers a math-driven blueprint for online trainers to reach \$20K/month using AI content systems and interactive lead magnets.

Contents

-  Sponsors & Show Intro
-  Super Chat: AI Tools for Workflow Automation
-  Habit 1: Weekend Cheating (The Saturday Bank Robbery)
-  Habit 2: Drinking Your Calories
-  Habit 3: Not Tracking Calories
-  Habit 4: Keeping Junk Food in Your Environment
-  Habit 5: Not Moving Enough — The 20,000-Step Cheat Code
-  Online Fitness Business: Working Backwards from \$20K/Month
-  Content Strategy: Batching, Outliers & AI Editing
-  Lead Generation: Interactive Tools & The Flex Pitch
-  Super Chat: Supplements & TRT Stack
-  Super Chat: Emergency Fund & Financial Q&A

Sponsors & Show Intro [0:34](#)

- **Live AI Training Event** — free, happening Sunday at 7 PM Eastern
 - Topic: how to grow an online fitness business using AI
 - Promises to cover: getting more clients, making more sales, using AI as an online trainer
 - Register via first link in description
- **GoHighLevel (GHL)** — Brandon's primary CRM sponsor
 - Claims to have used GHL for ~10 years
 - Every email and text message sent to his audience goes through GHL
 - Sign up gets 30-day free trial plus Brandon's own templates:
 - Landing page templates
 - Email campaign templates

- Text message campaign templates
- Describes it as "a business in a box"

Super Chat: AI Tools for Workflow Automation 0:34

- Question from Alex: what AI programs (besides ChatGPT/Claude) help manage A/E builds and workflows?
- Brandon's answer: needs more specifics about the workflow to give precise advice
- Top recommendations for automation and coding tasks:
 - **Codex** — Brandon's personal favorite; says he can't think of anything he couldn't do with it, especially with the new "Arista" model
 - **Claude Code** — popular alternative; many people prefer it
- Points to his video about making money with ChatGPT Arista / ChatGPT 6 for more ideas

Habit 1: Weekend Cheating (The Saturday Bank Robbery) 5:20

- The core problem: people are disciplined Monday–Friday then blow the entire deficit on weekends
- The weekly arc he describes:
 - Monday–Thursday: prepped meals, tracking calories, protein dialed in, gym at 6 AM, 10,000 steps, no alcohol
 - Friday morning: down a pound or two, feeling like "a budget David Goggins"
 - Friday ~6:47 PM: friends text, they go out — drinks, appetizers, desserts
 - Saturday brunch: French toast, mimosas at 11:30 AM — "fancy children's food"
 - Saturday night: go out again; Sunday: hungover, Uber Eats, eating crazy
 - Monday: stepped on scale, up 3 pounds
- The caloric bank account analogy:
 - Mon–Fri: 500-calorie deficit each day = **2,500-calorie deficit banked**
 - Saturday "walks in with a ski mask" — brunch, drinks, desserts, late-night snacks wipe it all out
 - Sunday is "driving the getaway car"

"Your fat cells don't have Google Calendar, bro. Every day is the same to your metabolism."

- "Mediocre mantras" to eliminate: *I deserve this / one won't hurt / one day won't hurt*
- Brandon's stance on cheat days:
 - Has not had a cheat meal in **~4 years**
 - A single cheat *meal* can be acceptable; a full cheat *day* is too risky for most people
 - Key reason beyond calories: **cheat meals induce cravings** for 3–4 days afterward
 - Junk food is "scientifically engineered to be delicious" and spikes dopamine
 - Clean food tastes worse by contrast after a cheat
 - Cravings typically persist Monday–Wednesday after a Sunday cheat day

- Once he stopped cheat meals entirely, cravings disappeared and adherence became effortless
- Practical takeaway: track your week as a whole unit, not individual days; you don't get weekends off

Habit 2: Drinking Your Calories 19:04

- Common offenders people undercount:
 - Fancy coffee drinks (caramel macchiatos, pumpkin spice, "Christmas explosion" drinks) — up to **480 calories**
 - Smoothies loaded with peanut butter, oat milk, protein powder, berries — "that's not a drink, that's groceries"
 - Fruit juice — "a scam"; juicing removes the fiber (the best part) and leaves only sugar + vitamins; nutritionally equivalent to Kool-Aid + a multivitamin
 - Sports drinks — example: 27-minute treadmill session burns ~180 calories, then person drinks a **240-calorie** sports drink → net caloric gain
 - Alcohol
- Why liquid calories are dangerous: you can consume 400 calories and barely notice; 400 calories of lean protein and vegetables is much harder to eat
- The rule: **calories are a limited resource — make them work for you** (real meals, primarily protein)
- What to drink instead: water, zero-calorie drinks, diet soda
 - Brandon has drunk diet soda daily since age 16; nearly 44 years old; 11 years without illness; full body MRIs and blood work all perfect
 - If afraid of artificial sweeteners, just drink water

Habit 3: Not Tracking Calories 24:41

- "If you're not tracking, you're slacking"
- People overestimate their calorie-estimation ability; intuitive eating works for teenagers and 20-year-olds, not for adult males trying to lose weight
- Common things people forget to count:
 - Butter used to cook eggs
 - Salad dressing
 - Hollandaise/sauces on steak
 - Handfuls of almonds throughout the day
 - Peanut butter — no one accidentally eats 600 calories of broccoli, but peanut butter scoops add up fast
- "Healthy ≠ low calorie" — avocados, nuts, olive oil are all healthy but can make you fat; your body doesn't issue a caloric refund for organic food
- Brandon's prescription (27 years of training, thousands of clients):

Metric	Formula
Daily calories	Body weight (lbs) × 10
Daily protein	1 gram per pound of body weight

- Example: 200 lb person → 2,000 calories/day, 200g protein/day
- **Adjust the calorie target downward as you lose weight** — confirmed in super chat: drop from 200 lb (2,000 cal) to 190 lb (1,900 cal) as weight decreases
- Why body weight × 10 instead of a small deficit:
 - A 200- or 500-calorie deficit is too easy to accidentally erase (e.g., 200 calories from a sugar-free honey mustard sauce he weighed on scale)
 - "You need a steep deficit because it's too easy to f*** up a small deficit"
- Why high protein is a cheat code — the thermogenic effect of food (TEF):
 - Fat: body burns **0–3%** of calories in digestion
 - Carbohydrates: body burns **5–15%** of calories in digestion
 - Protein: body burns **20–30%** of calories in digestion
 - Net result: consume 100 calories of protein → only absorb 70–80 calories
 - A high-protein diet puts you in an even deeper effective deficit
- Brandon has tracked calories for nearly **20 years**; started before MyFitnessPal (used notebooks)
- Analogy: not tracking calories is like running a business without tracking expenses — you'd go broke

Habit 4: Keeping Junk Food in Your Environment [38:34](#)

- If you eat a bag of chips every night, the solution is not more discipline — it's **stop buying chips**
- Brandon's personal example: favorite cheat food was Häagen-Dazs ice cream; solution — it's simply not in his home
- Core philosophy: **"Discipline is for amateurs."** Put yourself in a position where the right decision is the default response
- The Friction Framework:
 - Decrease friction for behaviors you want to do more of → make them the default
 - Increase friction for behaviors you want to avoid → make them annoying
 - Amazon example: Subscribe & Save button is huge and obvious (low friction to subscribe); canceling requires navigating multiple menus to find a tiny text button (high friction to cancel) — this is deliberate
 - Apply same logic to food: ice cream not in house → must call Uber Eats, wait for half-melted delivery, navigate private elevator confusion → at some point "you realize you don't want it that bad"
- Positive application: fill house with healthy food, have meals prepped, keep calorie-appropriate foods in the fridge ready to eat
- "Your environment should make getting lean easy, not turn everything into a psychological experiment"



Habit 5: Not Moving Enough — The 20,000-Step Cheat Code 45:46

- The sedentary modern day: wake up → 15 feet to computer → work 8 hours → drive to gym → 1 hour lift + 20 min cardio → drive home → couch → Netflix → sleep = "human house plant"
- Why traditional cardio is overrated for fat loss:
 - Running 1 mile burns ~100 calories — less than a banana or a handful of almonds
 - "It's called cardio, not fat burn" — great for cardiovascular health, not efficient at burning fat
 - High-intensity cardio also stresses joints and CNS, affects gym performance
- The prescription: **20,000 steps per day**
 - Burns between **800 and 1,000 extra calories per day**
 - Walking requires zero recovery; won't affect lifting performance
 - Every person Brandon has trained who hit this target got in the best shape of their life
- How to fit 20,000 steps into a schedule:
 - Morning: walk 30 minutes → ~3,000 steps
 - After lunch: walk 30 minutes (use half of lunch break) → ~3,000 steps
 - After work: walk 60 minutes (make it social — family, friends, walk club) → ~6,000 steps
 - Every hour during the workday: 10-minute walk × 8 hours → remaining ~8,000 steps
- Response to people who say it's impossible at their job: "It sounds like you're doing some real low-value work if they're clocking you like that." Brandon has 30 employees and doesn't care what they do all day as long as work gets done
- "If you argue for your own limitations, you get to keep them"
- If 20,000 is truly unattainable, do as many as you can — "don't let what you can't do stop you from doing what you can do"



Online Fitness Business: Working Backwards from \$20K/Month 60:51

- Context: Brandon made his first million as an online trainer; built multiple multi-million dollar fitness businesses; helped **15,000+ people** grow online fitness businesses
- The core principle: **turn the goal into math**, not hope or random posting
- Pricing structure he teaches:
 - 16-week program: **\$997–\$1,000**
 - Monthly: **\$297–\$300**
 - Weekly: **\$80/week**
 - In-person trainers charge \$100–\$300/session × 3 sessions/week = ~\$1,000/week for worse service
 - Online trainers charge less and deliver more (diet tracking, daily accountability, macros)
- Even at the lowest price point: 25 clients × \$80/week × 52 weeks = **\$104,000/year** — equivalent to a doctor fresh out of residency
- The reverse-engineering math framework:

Step	Calculation	Example (experienced)	Example (beginner)
1. Sales needed	Goal revenue ÷ avg. cash per call	\$20K ÷ \$1,000 = 20 sales	\$20K ÷ \$300 = ~67 sales
2. Calls needed	Sales needed ÷ close rate	20 ÷ 25% = 80 calls	—
3. Bookings needed	Calls needed ÷ show rate	80 ÷ 80% = 100 bookings	—
4. Leads needed	Bookings needed ÷ booking rate	100 ÷ 10% = 1,000 leads	—
5. Daily leads	Total leads ÷ 30 days	1,000 ÷ 30 ≈ 33 leads/day	—

- Once you know daily lead goal → figure out how much content to post to generate that many leads
- Student results: Alejandra made **\$9K in her first 28 days**; Corey Armstrong grew from broke in-person trainer with 2,000 followers to 300K Instagram / 500K YouTube subscribers / **\$470K last year** / **\$40K last month**; community member "American Stallion" doing **\$80–90K/month organic**; Kelly Nicole went from \$1–2K/month to **\$20K/month** at age 23 while still in college



Content Strategy: Batching, Outliers & AI Editing [72:53](#)

- Daily content quota for top earners in his community:
 - **3–5 short-form videos (Reels) per day** — post same content to YouTube Shorts and TikTok
 - **2–3 carousels per day** — Reels reach new audiences; carousels reach existing audience
 - **1 call-to-action on Stories per day** (the "Flex Pitch" — see below)
- Why batching is essential: impossible to create 3–5 videos per day on the fly
- Content batching process — treat it like meal prep:
 - **Day 1:** Brainstorm ideas — need 31 content ideas (for 3/day over 30 days); use "niche hacking" / 10x outlier method
 - **Day 2:** Write all scripts using AI (structure in your own voice)
 - **Day 3:** Film everything in one session
 - Bring multiple shirts to gym, keep changing so videos look different
 - Or wear the same thing every video (Dan Martell method — batch a year, no one notices)
 - Only have to set up once, like setting up a kitchen for a week of meal prep
 - **Day 4:** Edit everything (AI does most heavy lifting now)
 - **Day 5:** Schedule everything via GoHighLevel (one platform → pushes to Instagram, TikTok, YouTube simultaneously)
- Brandon used this exact process when starting YouTube: filmed 14 videos in a single day, scripted and edited in separate dedicated days, posted 2 long-form videos per day while working multiple jobs
- Finding 10x outliers (viral content to model, not steal):
 - **Definition:** A video with 10x more views than the creator has followers (e.g., 1M views, 100K followers)

- **Method 1 — Manual + Google Gemini:**
 - Use ~\$5 tool "TikTok Instagram Sorter" to find and download high-view videos in your niche
 - Drop the MP4 into Google Gemini (handles video natively, unlike other LLMs)
 - Prompt: "Analyze this viral video. Explain why it went viral. Then interview me until you have enough info to write a script in this format but with my own words and knowledge"
 - Gemini breaks down why it went viral and generates a custom script draft
- **Method 2 — Vid IQ plugin in ChatGPT:**
 - Set up Vid IQ as a plugin, ask it to find top-performing IG Reels in the fitness niche
 - Returns creator, view count, and outlier score (example shown: 1.4M views = ~200x outlier)
- **Method 3 — Free Viral Content Vault:**
 - Brandon's team scours the internet for fitness-niche outliers and dumps them into a Notion database
 - Over 100 outliers already loaded, updated weekly — link in description, free
- The music analogy: same chord progression, same key = not copying; different lyrics and melody = your own content. Borrow the format/hook/angle, never the content itself
- AI editing with ChatGPT Codex (Arista model):
 - Prompt example: "Edit this video, remove the takes/dead spaces, add captions, add upbeat hip-hop inspired music"
 - Result: cuts mistakes, adds graphics — "not perfect, but way better than doing every one by hand"
 - Used to be the most time-consuming step; now AI does most of it
- Carousel creation with custom ChatGPT Codex skill ("King Keto Photo Carousel" skill):
 - Drop a YouTube video or Reel into the skill
 - It structures the content into slides, specifies how many photos needed
 - Drop in real photos of yourself → generates Instagram carousel with caption
 - Result looks authentic (real photos, real words) and performs well

Lead Generation: Interactive Tools & The Flex Pitch [92:56](#)

- **The Flex Pitch (Story selling strategy):**
 - Treat your Instagram Stories like a reality show — document your day (food, workouts, life)
 - Insert at least one pitch for your offer every day surrounded by real lifestyle content
 - Structure: life content → commercial break (pitch) → back to life content
 - Works because people tune in for the show; a pure-pitch story feels like an ad and gets skipped
 - Include: what you're eating and why, your workout, client testimonials, transformation photos, CTA like "DM me 'fat loss'"
- **Comment-triggered lead magnets:**
 - Post content with CTA: "Comment [word] and I'll send you my free [tool]"
 - Use GoHighLevel (or ManyChat) to auto-DM the lead magnet when they comment

- Then follow up in DMs → book a sales call
- **Interactive lead magnet vs. PDF:**
 - PDFs work but interactive tools are significantly more valuable
 - Brandon's example: "Ripped Roadmap" free assessment tool
 - User inputs: gender, age, height, current weight, goal
 - Uploads a photo → AI analyzes physique, estimates body fat %
 - Collects: name, phone number, email (enabling multi-channel follow-up — DM, email, phone)
 - Outputs: estimated body fat, pounds to lose, daily calorie target, macro breakdown
 - Ends with a VSSL (video sales letter) and direct link to book a strategy call
 - Built entirely in GoHighLevel's AI Studio (similar to Lovable)
 - Process: brainstormed with ChatGPT → had ChatGPT write the prompt → pasted into GHL AI Studio → GHL built the tool
 - GHL CRM then handles all follow-up emails, texts, and automations from one place
- **Ads strategy:**
 - Don't run ads until making **\$5–10K/month** organically
 - Run **follower ads** via Meta Ads Manager (never the Instagram "Boost" button — "designed by Zuckerberg to steal money from lazy people")
 - Find your best organic content (most engagement, followers, leads) → promote it as an ad
 - Benefit: ad engagement gets attributed back to the organic post too
 - Target cost: **under \$1 per follower**; Brandon has achieved **\$0.20–\$0.30 per follower** with winning content
 - If followers cost more than \$1, the content probably isn't good enough — pick better content
- Full daily execution summary:
 - 3–5 Reels/day (lean toward 5 if serious)
 - 1 Story CTA (Flex Pitch) per day
 - 2 carousels per day
 - Every piece of content has a CTA to comment a keyword
 - GoHighLevel auto-DMs the interactive lead magnet
 - Follow up → sales call → close

Super Chat: Supplements & TRT Stack [116:39](#)

- Question from Aaron: what supplements and vitamins does Brandon currently take?
- Daily supplements:
 - Vitamin C
 - Vitamin D
 - Whey protein (multiple shakes per day)
 - Fish oil

- **Creatine — 200 grams per day** (since age 16; says he forgets to mention it because it's so ingrained)
- Unisom (for sleep at night)
- Weekly:
 - Tirzepatide peptide (GLP-1 class)
- Nightly:
 - Tesamorelin (growth hormone releasing peptide)
- Testosterone Replacement Therapy (TRT):
 - Started just before age 40; currently ~44 years old
 - Prescribed by his doctor; maintains testosterone at **~900 ng/dL**
 - Notes his natural testosterone in his 20s was 1,200–1,400 ng/dL, so TRT is still below his youthful peak — "it's real replacement therapy"

Super Chat: Emergency Fund & Financial Q&A 55:05

- **NBA accounting system question (Nico):** Does overtime income get allocated at different percentages?
 - Answer: No — all money counts the same regardless of source
- **Emergency fund question (Pursue Excellence):** Where to park 6 months of emergency savings — T-bills vs. HYSA vs. low-risk/high-return?
 - Brandon: "Low-risk, high-return is an oxymoron" — typically inversely related
 - Recommendation: park it in a **High-Yield Savings Account (HYSA)**
 - The job of emergency fund money is **not** to grow, multiply, or compound — its only job is insurance if things go wrong
 - Secondary purpose: gives you confidence to take more risk elsewhere, knowing 6 months of bills are covered
- **Wife/girlfriend expenses (Nico):** Include in monthly expenses?
 - Basic necessities (staying alive, hair, etc.) — yes, include
 - Luxury items — come from separate "other accounts"